



# **STRUCTURE OF THE GOVERNMENT OF PAKISTAN**

**Course Instructor**

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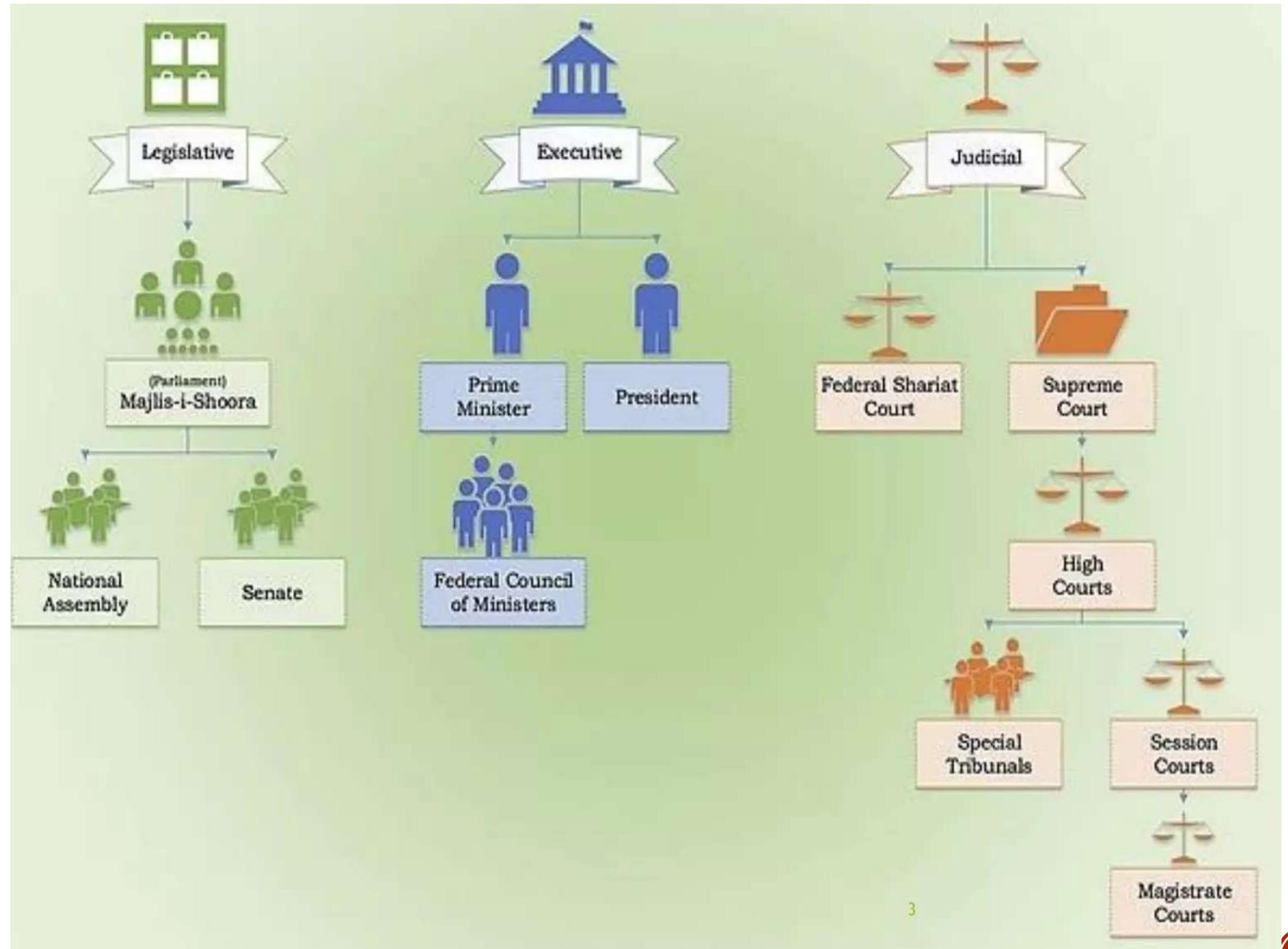
# INTRODUCTION

- Pakistan operates under a Federal Parliamentary Republic system, as established by the 1973 Constitution.
- The government is divided into three main branches:
  - Legislative: Responsible for making laws.
  - Executive: Responsible for implementing laws.
  - Judicial: Responsible for interpreting laws.





# STRUCTURE



# LEGISLATIVE BRANCH: THE PARLIAMENT OF PAKISTAN

- The Parliament, known as Majlis-e-Shūrā, is the supreme legislative body.
- It is a bicameral legislature, consisting of:
  - **National Assembly (Lower House):**
    - Must be a **citizen of Pakistan**.
    - Comprises 336 members:
      - Parity Basis Distribution
      - 272 general seats elected directly by the people.
      - 60 seats reserved for women.
      - 10 seats reserved for non-Muslims.
    - Members serve a five-year term.
    - Age: National Assembly → **25 years** minimum as per → **Article 62(1)(b)**
  - **Senate (Upper House):**
    - Must be a **citizen of Pakistan**.
    - 96 members (after the 18th Amendment)..
    - Equal Basis Distribution
    - Members are elected indirectly by the provincial assemblies.
    - Each member serves a six-year term.
    - Age: National Assembly → **30 years** minimum as per → **Article 62(1)(b)**
- **Functions of the Parliament**
  - **Legislation:** It enacts laws under the Constitution.
  - **Oversight:** It monitors & questions government policies.
  - **Financial Control:** It approves the federal budget & oversees public expenditures.

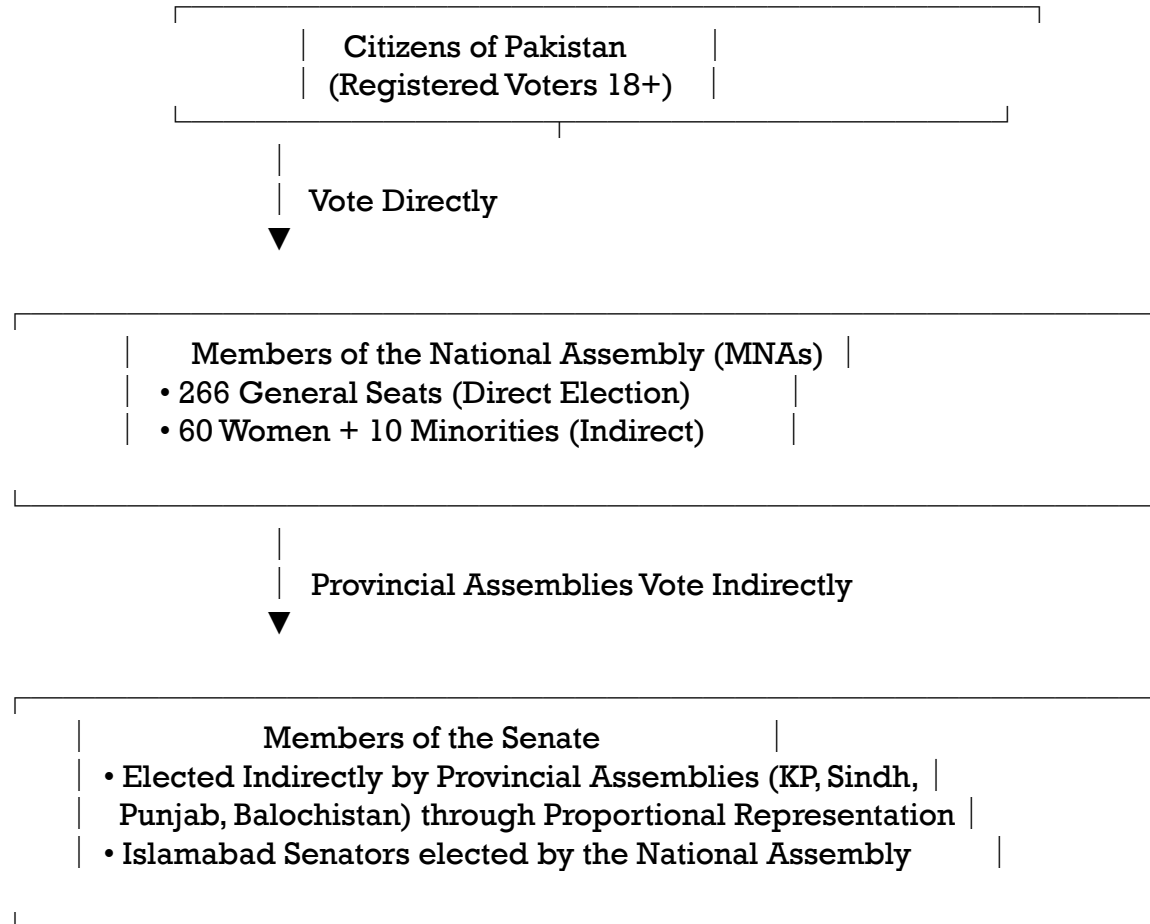
# SENATE VS. NA SEATS DISTRIBUTION

| Region/Province                    | Number of Senators | Details                                              |
|------------------------------------|--------------------|------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Punjab</b>                      | 23                 | 14 General, 4 Technocrats/Ulema, 4 Women, 1 Minority |
| <b>Sindh</b>                       | 23                 | 14 General, 4 Technocrats/Ulema, 4 Women, 1 Minority |
| <b>Khyber Pakhtunkhwa (KP)</b>     | 23                 | 14 General, 4 Technocrats/Ulema, 4 Women, 1 Minority |
| <b>Balochistan</b>                 | 23                 | 14 General, 4 Technocrats/Ulema, 4 Women, 1 Minority |
| <b>Islamabad Capital Territory</b> | 4                  | 2 General, 1 Technocrat/Ulema, 1 Woman               |

| Province / Area                     | General Seats | Women/Minority Seats | Total Provincial Seats |
|-------------------------------------|---------------|----------------------|------------------------|
| <b>Punjab</b>                       | 141           | 32                   | <b>173</b>             |
| <b>Sindh</b>                        | 61            | 14                   | <b>75</b>              |
| <b>Khyber Pakhtunkhwa (KP)</b>      | 45            | 10                   | <b>55</b>              |
| <b>Balochistan</b>                  | 16            | 4                    | <b>20</b>              |
| <b>Islamabad Capital Territory</b>  | 3             | —                    | <b>3</b>               |
| <b>Total (After 25th Amendment)</b> | <b>266</b>    | <b>60+10</b>         | <b>336</b>             |



# VOTERS/ELECTIONS OF THE SENATE & NA



# EXECUTIVE BRANCH

- The Executive is responsible for the implementation of laws and the administration of government affairs.
- It comprises:
  - **Prime Minister:**
    - Serves as the **Chief Executive** of Pakistan.
    - Elected by the National Assembly.
    - Appoints the federal cabinet and oversees the functioning of government departments.
    - Current PM of Pakistan (Shehbaz Sharif – 23<sup>rd</sup>).
  - **President:**
    - Acts as the **ceremonial Head of State**.
    - Elected for a **five-year term** by an electoral college comprising members of the Senate, National Assembly, and Provincial Assemblies.
    - Performs duties on the advice of the Prime Minister.
    - Current President of Pakistan (Asif Ali Zardari – 14<sup>th</sup>).



# JUDICIAL BRANCH

- The Judiciary is independent and ensures the rule of law and constitutional supremacy.
- It includes:
- **Supreme Court:**
  - The highest court in Pakistan.
  - Headed by the **Chief Justice of Pakistan**.
  - Comprises the Chief Justice and other judges appointed by the President in consultation with the Chief Justice.
  - Current CJP (Yahya Afridi – 30<sup>th</sup>).
- **High Courts:**
  - One in each province and the Islamabad Capital Territory (Total 05 High Courts)
  - Hear appeals from lower courts and have original jurisdiction in certain cases.
- **Lower Courts:**
  - Include District & Sessions Courts, Civil Courts, Family Courts, Anti-Terrorism Courts, Sharia Courts, and Environmental Courts.
  - Handle civil and criminal cases at the grassroots level.





**Thank you for your time and attention!**

**Hopefully, I will see you in the next class. Until then, take care, & have a great day!**

